Animals and birds play an important role in spreading seeds of various plants. The digestive enzymes in the digestive system of the birds soften the protective layer of the seeds and make it easier to germinate.

If these natural relationship between animals and plants are affected, it shows its impact on economy too.

Other uses of plants

1. Maintain soil fertility

Plants maintain soil fertility. Their droppings and shedding of leaves, fruits and other parts degrade in the soil to form humus. This humus increases soil fertility. Eg. Plants like blue green algae and bacteria Pseudomonas are extensively used to fix nitrogen in the soil for agriculture.

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2. Prevent soil erosion

Plants when grown in dense will prevent **soil erosion** (ie) in times of wind or flood, the fertile top layer of soil is carried away by air or water. This is prevented by plants if grown around.

3. Bio – fuels

Some plants are also grown for the sake of bio - fuels. Plant fuel is less toxic as it does not emit harmful gases and also less expensive. **Eg. Jatropha.** Even the plant waste is used to generate electricity. **eg: Sugar mills**

DO YOU KNOW?

Pala spinach

Osteo arthritis is a joint disease affecting joints and knee of any age people. Currently Indian scientists at CDRI (Central Drug Research Institute – Lucknow) have made a nano formulation from the Palak (Pala spinach) to cure this disease.

4. Rubber and Natural plastic

We obtain rubber for tyre, wiring, seats etc from plants. Natural plastics are also produced from plants which are biodegradable. So it does not do harm to our environment.



5. Neem Oil coated Urea

Farmers in India uses urea as a fertilizer to increase the agricultural productivity. Indian Scientists made Neem Coated urea which released nitrogen gradualy and helps the plants to absorb maximum nitrogen. It reduces the impact of urea on an environment.

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